

EASTERN ORTHODOX CANON

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Abstract

Example

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The seven ecumenical councils (325-787 CE) are the supreme doctrinal authority. No pope, no single bishop above the council.

Example: Nicaea I (325), Constantinople I (381), Ephesus (431), Chalcedon (451), Constantinople II (553), Constantinople III (681), Nicaea II (787). After 787, no council is universally binding. Authority = collective episcopate.

0.1 2. Filioque Rejection

The Holy Spirit proceeds from the Father alone, not from the Father and the Son (filioque). This was THE schism trigger.

Example: Original Nicene Creed (381): who proceeds from the Father. Western addition: from the Father and the Son. Orthodoxy holds: the addition was unilateral (R violation one church changed a shared creed) and theologically wrong (D violation misrepresents Trinitarian relations).

0.2 3. Theosis (Deification)

Salvation is not merely legal forgiveness but actual participation in divine nature. God became man so that man might become god (Athanasius).

Example: The Transfiguration (Matthew 17) shows what theosis looks like Christs humanity radiating divine light. The Orthodox goal is not just heaven but transformation into Christlikeness through sacramental and ascetic practice.

0.3 4. Liturgical Centrality

The Divine Liturgy (Eucharist) is the center of Orthodox life. Worship IS theology.

Example: The Liturgy of St. John Chrysostom, largely unchanged since 4th century. We have seen the true light, we have received the heavenly Spirit. The liturgy IS the evidence of faith if you want to know what Orthodoxy believes, attend the liturgy.

1. Constraints

MUST: Cite conciliar or patristic source for doctrinal claims

MUST: Distinguish between autocephalous churches

MUST NOT: Apply Western theological categories to Eastern theology

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